

Summary

I'm a software engineer, writer, speaker, leader, and accessibility advocate with 12+ years of experience. My background is mostly in developer productivity and developer experience, focusing on design systems, accessibility, developer tooling, automated testing, and CI/CD. I enjoy working on the frontend using React, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.

I make the people, teams, and companies I work with better. I've contributed to interviewing working groups, company engineering blogs, frontend guilds, and have led hundreds of engineers through onboarding trainings. I love teaching, reading, and writing. My 130+ blog posts have been viewed over 2 million times, I've spoken at 15+ tech conferences, and I've been interviewed as a guest on several podcasts.

For more info and to see 90+ apps and side projects I've built, visit my web portfolio at <http://tylerhawkins.info>, check out my GitHub profile at <https://github.com/thawkin3>, or read my blog at <https://dev.to/thawkin3>.

Core Skills

JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, HTML5, CSS3, testing, accessibility, design systems, developer tooling, AI, writing, teaching, mentoring, and leadership

Other technologies I've used: Figma, Babel, Webpack, Rollup, Redux, Node.js, Express, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, GraphQL, Next.js, Claude Code, Cursor, Storybook, ESLint, Prettier, Buildkite, Docker, Kubernetes, MUI, Radix, yarn, npm, jQuery, AngularJS (1.x), PHP, Java, SQL, Git, GitHub, GitLab, and Jira. I'm also an AWS Certified Developer Associate.

Education

B.S. in Statistics; Psychology Minor; 3.95 GPA; Brigham Young University

Work Experience

Staff Software Engineer, Tech Lead at Webflow

Oct 2024 – Jun 2026

Senior Software Engineer at Webflow

Jun 2023 – Oct 2024

- Led our design system team of four engineers
- Released a major UI reskin that was revealed during Webflow Conf in October 2023
- Built theming solutions so users can customize their UI (light/dark theme and appearance settings)
- Built observability tooling and dashboards to visualize which systems make up our UI
- Created and led Webflow's monthly frontend engineering onboarding training for new hires
- Helped run our Webflow engineering blog and contributed several blog posts of my own
- Revamped our engineering interviewing process, questions, and rubrics
- Posted an "Accessibility Tip of the Day" every work day for 365 days
- Created Webflow's first ever Accessibility Conformance Report (ACR) to unblock many sales deals
- Built and maintained our design system documentation site
- Frequently presented in engineering all-hands meetings, guild meetings, and working groups
- Developed AI rules and skills to help the rest of our organization use our design system effectively

Senior Software Engineer, Tech Lead at Adobe

Feb 2021 – Jun 2023

- Interviewed, hired, and led a team of 6 software engineers
- Created onboarding docs, team docs, and processes for a brand new engineering team
- Improved our app's accessibility support in 13 additional WCAG 2.1 AA success criteria (moved up from 23 to 36)
- Remediated our top 10 most used pages (accounts for 65% of all Workfront page traffic)
- Co-founded the Accessibility Guild and gave monthly presentations and workshops
- Published Workfront's first public Accessibility Conformance Report (ACR)
- Added accessibility trainings to our new hire onboarding program
- Established company-wide processes for logging and handling accessibility issues
- Configured an Axe Monitor web crawler and reporting dashboard
- Reduced on-call PagerDuty alerts by 94% for our team
- Implemented BYOK (bring your own key) functionality for one of our microservices

Senior Software Engineer, Tech Lead at Workfront

Mar 2020 – Feb 2021

- Improved test coverage on our design system from 60% to 95% and squashed the bugs
- Implemented a “zero-defect” bug triage process on our team and drove adoption of it for the rest of the engineering organization
- Advocated for accessibility improvements and taught 20+ accessibility workshops
- Conducted 30+ interviews for various open positions (SE II, Sr. SE, Eng Mgr, A11y SME)
- Frequently presented in our internal conference, engineering lunch-and-learns, and team trainings

Principal UI Architect at Yunique (Part-time, Contract)

Jul 2022 – Sep 2024

- Implemented best practices in 30+ repos that had very few existing standards (ESLint, Prettier, Jest, React Testing Library, CI pipelines, dependency upgrades, accessibility, documentation)
- Presented monthly trainings to the software development department

Tech Blogger and Writer at Dev Spotlight (Freelance)

Feb 2020 – present

- Published 130+ articles on Medium, Dev, DZone, Hacker Noon, and freeCodeCamp
- Gained over 2 million views since 2020
- Write for dozens of clients anywhere from Fortune 500 companies to tech startups
- Write about software engineering, JavaScript, React, accessibility, testing, engineering leadership, and engineering culture

Senior Software Engineer at Instructure

Feb 2020 – Mar 2020

Software Engineer, Tech Lead at Instructure

Feb 2019 – Feb 2020

- Improved our build tools, frontend architecture, and component library
- Consistently delivered high-quality feature releases and was a top contributor
- Presented in multiple engineering-wide trainings (TDD, Webpack, Storybook)

Senior UI Developer at Yunique

Oct 2018 – Feb 2019

UI Developer at Yunique

Sep 2017 – Oct 2018

- Launched user-generated content platform, Looks (React, Node, AWS)
- Led development for a new line of skin care products; over \$2 million in revenue the first day

- Developed a library of reusable React components
- Taught React/JavaScript workshops and mentored other UI developers

Front End Developer at Qualtrics

Oct 2015 – Sep 2017

- Scoped, priced, sold, developed, tested, and maintained over \$700k worth of custom engineering solutions for hundreds of clients (HTML, CSS, JS, PHP, SQL, jQuery, AngularJS)
- Built custom survey question types like E-Signature, Tinder Swipe, and Audio Recorder
- Created a catalog of services offered by Professional Services to enable sales reps to help further sell our custom solutions and gain a better understanding of what our team can do (PHP, SQL, JS)
- Built a support site for our conjoint analysis application (AngularJS)

Theme Designer at Qualtrics

Jun 2015 – Oct 2015

- Designed over 800 survey themes for clients of all tiers (HTML, CSS)
- Led a movement to update clients' old and outdated survey themes to help preserve a good brand image for Qualtrics

Product Specialist at Qualtrics

Apr 2014 – Jun 2015

- Provided support for Qualtrics' clients; had over 10,000 client interactions via phone and email
- Ranked #1 in performance out of 70 people for three quarters (in the top 10% for all other quarters)

Volunteer Representative (Missionary)

Jul 2011 – Jul 2013

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

- Two-year full-time mission serving the people of Iowa, Illinois, and Missouri